

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 1 - The True Republic

Chapter 08 - What Is a True Republic

EP05 — What Is a True Republic?

Series: True Republic **Type:** Street / Campus Interview + Narration Hybrid **Core Question:** "What do you think a True Republic actually is?"

The Seed Being Planted

Most people confuse a republic with a democracy, or with the specific government they live under. A True Republic in the Living Age sense is not a form of government — it is a voluntary order built on natural law, conscience, and decentralized spontaneous cooperation among free people.

From The Spiral Steward: "By day, the architecture of a free world: the True Republic, built on voluntary association, natural law, conscience, and the decentralized spontaneous order of free people."

This episode explores what people actually mean when they say they believe in freedom — and whether the system they live under reflects it.

Interview Arc

Opening Question

"What do you think a True Republic is?"

Follow-Up Questions

- "Is America a republic right now?"
- "What's the difference between a republic and a democracy?"

- "Can a republic survive if its people don't govern themselves?"
- "If representatives make decisions you never agreed to — are you being represented?"
- "What would voluntary cooperation look like as a foundation for society?"
- "Is there a difference between a republic of laws and a republic of conscience?"

The Contradiction That Often Emerges

People defend the idea of the republic while acknowledging the current system doesn't resemble it. The seed: maybe the True Republic was never a government form at all — maybe it's what emerges when people take full responsibility for their own lives and choices.

Cold Open Script (Narrator)

"The founders called it a republic. Not a democracy. Not an empire. A republic — res publica — the public thing. The thing that belongs to all of us. So when did it start belonging to them?"

Closing Narration

The True Republic is not a destination on a map. It is a way of being — voluntary, self-governing, conscious, decentralized. It is what the spiral produces when enough people stop waiting for rulers and start living as if they are already free.

Source Quotes

Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.

"A true Republic is not a form of government or a state with the monopoly on legitimate use of force but a network of voluntary action where each individual follows their own conscience instead of arbitrary rules from human hierarchy."

"The True Republic is born not from coercion, but from conversation. Not from authority, but from inquiry. Not from obedience, but from awareness. Its mission is simple: to question the beliefs of people and work through what people think and why and lead them towards the truth."

"This is the True Republic: a civilization born of necessity, sustained by truth."

"The only campaign I would involve myself in is one where the main goal was not to win but to do what is right. The campaign of the true Republic isn't about the candidate but about

doing the right thing."

"From progressive Democrat to anarchist libertarian — from the center of control to the edge of freedom."

"2 nations created by creed: America and Israel. Both creeds corrupted by the worldly ruler — but their original creed was loyalty to God over man. True America is decentralized defense."

"The last day of the new republic was the first day of the True Republic."

The Living Age Trilogy